Heights of Korowai 'Office Hours' Rogaine
Sunday 2 December '07

Dear Team,

Thank you for your entry. Your Team number is:
Please remember it.

As team contact person, please ensure all team members are familiar with this information. It is also accessible at www.rogaine.org.nz. We hope you enjoy this event.

Getting to the event
REGISTRATION is at the south-west end of Lake Lyndon near Porters Pass, off SH 73, a 60 minute, 75 km drive west of Christchurch on SH 73. After descending Porters Pass heading towards Arthurs Pass, turn left at the Ryton Station-Lake Coleridge sign just before Lake Lyndon, and drive around the lake. Registration is at the A-frame lodge at the far end of the lake. Please park considerately. The START/FINISH is 2.5km further down the road from the A-frame.

Registration and start
Registration starts at **7.15 am** from when maps and electronic wrist-tags are issued. Ensure your team is together and that you have your **completed indemnity form** with you. Briefing is at **8.45 am** at the start/finish. Ensure that you register the electronic wrist-tag you have been given on one of the BRIEF punches which will be available at this briefing. The event will start at **9.00 am**. For details on using the Navlight Electronic Scoring System see the homepage of the website www.rogaine.org.nz.

The event will close at **4 pm sharp** at the START/FINISH. If you finish after that you will be penalised 10 points per minute late.

Finish
As soon as you finish, register your wrist-tag on any one of several FINISH Punches, assemble your team, and then present yourselves to the computer desk to have your wrist-tags removed and scored. Wait for an immediate printout of your score. If you have any disagreement with it, see the event organizer, NOT the scoring team. Scores will be notified on the day and published on www.rogaine.org.nz as soon as possible after the event.

Event chronology

7.15 am	REGISTRATION OPENS, A-Frame Lodge Route planning and preparation
8.30 am	Teams drive by now to Start/Finish, 2.5 km south-west of A-Frame
8.45 am	Briefing
9 am	START
4 pm	FINISH

We will provide a light meal from 4.30 pm, at the A-frame Lodge.

What to bring
Clothing and safety equipment is listed under 'Safety Sheet'. You will also need

- a range of marker pens, pencils and highlighters, pins and string, and ruler, for planning and measuring your route before you start
- eating utensils for after the event
- a camp stool and table or board for course planning (optional but handy)

Navigation devices such as GPS or altimeter **not allowed**.

Food and drink
Carry enough for a long day in the field. You may return to the start-finish at any time for a rest, or a drink. Water refill drops are marked on the map. We have no reason to think water from the back, steepland streams is unsafe to drink. We recommend you each carry at least 2 litres of water.

Your back country travel skills.
If your team lacks confidence in finding its way in moderate, untracked tramping terrain, we suggest you confine your route to more accessible check points.

Particular hazards:
Roads. The road is open at all times. You must always obey the Road Code rules**.**
Fire risk. The area is a very high fire risk. Strictly, no fires on the course or at the car park. Please take great care with fire risk in the car park.

Cancellation
This event will only be cancelled if conditions are extreme, to be notified at the start. The organisers reserve the right to shorten the event for safety or other reasons.

Registration and event procedure
At the registration desk your team must present the completed Indemnity and Emergency Contact Form. Ensure you have entered your team number on the form. You will then be issued with:

- one event map and a checkpoint description sheet per team member. The map size is A3 at a scale of 1:25 000. A zip-loc plastic bag to protect the map will be provided.
- a single black/white version of the map to be used as your "flight plan". Enter your team number and plot your intended route on this map, including direction of travel, and return it to registration before you start. (You may subsequently modify your route according to conditions as you progress).
- An electronic wrist-tag - two per team. This MUST be worn on the wrist with the security band provided.

We recommend you spend at least 45 minutes planning your route, making the day more enjoyable and rewarding. You should plan your route carefully to challenge your map reading and navigation skills but to stay within the safe limits set by the terrain and weather, your experience and fitness.

Your team may visit any number of checkpoints and in any order. Your aim is to maximise your 'score'. There are 42 checkpoints, each with a unique number. The score value is the first digit followed by a zero. Thus check point number 23 has a score of 20 points and 91 a score of 90 points.

All members of your team must attend the event briefing. Each person in your team issued with a Tag must register their Tag on one of the BRIEF Punches as you enter the briefing area. All teams start the event together. Concentrate on your own team plan; do not try to follow other teams.

Each checkpoint comprises an orange/white flag on a stake or tied to a bush or post etc., and an electronic punch. As they have been placed in the field up to a week before the event we cannot be certain that all are still intact. If a checkpoint is missing, you must be able to describe its presumed original location to the score keepers to be credited with the points.

When you visit a checkpoint, EACH COMPETITOR must place the Punch in their wrist-tag until a red flashing light is seen. (Less than 3 seconds, and probably half a second.). If the punch doesn't flash, write down the 3-letter code visible inside it. (See the top of the homepage of the website www.rogaine.org.nz to access further details on 'NAVLIGHT').

Rogaine safety and environmental sheet, pre-event briefing

Safety Sheet
Heights of Korowai 7 hour 'Office Hours' Rogaine
- Sunday 2 December 2007

Compulsory clothes and equipment per team member:

thermal top & trousers — thermal hat and gloves
shower proof/windproof coat — survival sheet or pack liner
whistle,
food, water bottle — first aid kit, **per team**
at least one compass, **per team**
suitable, robust, well-fitting footwear with well-treaded soles.

Your gear is your own responsibility. There will be no compulsory gear check but the organisers reserve the right to do checks on a random or selective basis. You must be suitably equipped to start.

We **strongly recommend** you also carry
fully rainproof parka, second layer thermal top, long gaiters (there is much matagouri and other scrub to negotiate), showerproof over trousers, a high-viz garment, a compass each, torch, watch.

There is extensive and thick matagouri and turpentine scrub over much of the course. We strongly encourage you to wear long gaiters and possibly long trousers.

Safety is top priority during this event. Organisers and participants (you) have legal responsibilities for safety under the Health and Safety in Employment Act. Your responsibilities include:

- Being aware of and meeting all safety requirements specified by event organisers in writing or verbal briefings
- carrying all compulsory protective clothing and other safety equipment (see above).
- Advising your team member(s) of any medical conditions you have, your general level of fitness and other factors that may affect you adversely during the event.
- staying together as a team at all times, and providing mutual support, and helping any other team you find in difficulties.
- depositing an intended 'flight plan' map showing your intended course at registration before you start.
- advising organisers, and returning your tags, if you withdraw from the event, or when you finish. This is our safety check that you are no longer on the course and **IS COMPULSORY,**
- Being highly conscious of time and avoiding a late return – which results in a hefty points penalty as well as raises safety concerns.
- Being prepared to modify your plans to be more conservative if safety conditions dictate this.
- Monitoring team and individual progress and fitness and modifying plans as required
- Looking out for hazards, such as:

    - **Hypothermia.** Wind, water and cold temperatures can lead to exposure or hypothermia. Early symptoms are subtle (clumsiness, lethargy, slurred speech). Be prepared to seek shelter or to call it a day if conditions are severe, or if any of your team is becoming exhausted. In severe weather, keep off high, exposed ridges.
    - **Dehydration.** Drink lots of water – we suggest you carry at least 2 litres per person, (Water drops are marked on the map), be alert to heat exhaustion, seek shade, wear sunscreen.

- **Streams**. Do not cross streams if they are heavily swollen.
- Cliffs, slippery rocks, loose rocks, firm scree, incised creeks, gullies, slippery grass, hidden obstacles such as logs, loose fencing wire, etc. may be present throughout the event area.
- **Rock fall.** Be particularly careful about rocks falling from above, and avoid releasing them above team members or other teams. Shout out if you see falling rocks.
- **Fog/low cloud**. If in fog, orientate the map and yourself with a compass. If in doubt, don't climb into cloud, and descend out of it.
- **Road traffic**: There will be traffic on roads. No roads are closed during the event. The Road Code applies at all times,
- **Hunters**: We cannot guarantee that hunters will not be present in the area. We recommend teams carry a high-viz garment, and you keep highly visible, and heard, if you are concerned.

In the event of serious injury or exhaustion, make injured person warm and comfortable; arrange, if possible, to leave someone with the person; note your exact location on the map; seek help via the road. Emergency signal: repeated (6 or more) short blasts on whistle at about 1 second intervals, repeated each 1 to 5 minutes. Repeat if you hear one long blast.

Environmental care

We expect you to reinforce the rogaining ethic as an environmentally and socially friendly activity.

- Protect plants and animals
- Remove rubbish – More importantly, don't create it in the first place
- Bury Toilet waste - Better still, don't create it in the field - use the Portaloos provided at start finish where possible.
- Keep steams and lakes clean
- **Strictly no fires – this is the greatest environmental risk for the event**
- TREAD LIGHTLY wherever you go. Take particular care in wetlands areas – it is faster for you, and better for the plants, for you to walk around rather than through them. Avoid disturbing areas of rock-fields and screes, which may be home for plants and small animals.

Biosecurity Alert
DOC, and we, stress the need to be scrupulous regarding the risk of spreading the invasive algae Didymo, and other plant and animal pests in the event area.

Please ensure that prior to entering the area, vehicles, footwear, clothing (paying particular attention to velcro, boot treads, pockets and cuffs), bikes and other equipment are thoroughly cleaned and dried. This includes all items involved in competing or the organization/marshalling of the event, including vehicles.

BASIC INFORMATION

Rules in brief

- Use compass and rogaine event map only. GPS and altimeter units are not allowed, including watches with altimeters.
- Travel only on foot.
- Team members to stay within verbal contact of each other at all times. **All members** must approach within 20 metres of each checkpoint. (Your fellow competitors will be watching).
- If a check point is missing, be able to describe the local setting in detail to the organizer.
- When visiting the START/FINISH, all team members must report to the organiser and register a FINISH punch on their wrist tags. You may still go out again later.
- If a competitor wishes to withdraw, the entire team must return to START/FINISH and notify the organisers. (Team retains current points score.) Teams of one are not permitted.
- Event finishes at 4 pm. (or as specified at start).
- When your team finishes, **all** members **must** report to the finish area and register a FINISH punch on their wrist tags. Then immediately report to the scoring table to have your wrist-tags removed and scored

Procedure at each control

- All team members must use the electronic Punch to register on their wrist-tags. If a Punch fails to operate record its internal 3-letter code (visible through the clear plastic) to verify your visit, and after you finish and have returned your Tags inform the event organizer.

Points value, penalty points

- Check points 100, 101 are worth 100 points. Thereafter, check points 20 to 29, are worth 20 points, 30 to 39, 30 points, etc.
- 10 points penalty for each minute late. 30 minutes late - all points lost

Safety

- Carry and wear suitable clothing and equipment
- Team to remain together at all times
- Be alert to exhaustion, dehydration, sun, and/or hypothermia
- Help other teams having problems
- If your team withdraws from the event you **must report to admin**. Otherwise you will be reported overdue and a search will be mounted.
- Take **extreme care on roads, which remain open to traffic.**

Emergencies

- Emergency signal: repeated, short whistle blasts
- Repeat if you hear one long blast

Serious injury

- Make injured person warm and comfortable
- Leave someone with injured person if more than two in team.
- Note your exact location on map
- Seek help from other teams and/or go back to base by a direct route or the road.

Farm/land courtesy

- No **rubbish**, no **dogs**, no **fires**, no **firearms**
- Report any damage, etc. to event organisers
- Biosecurity alert - Didymo

CHECK, CLEAN, DRY



Photo: Stu Sutherland, Fish and Game

Background

Didymosphenia geminata (didymo) was first identified in New Zealand in October 2004. It has since been found in multiple rivers in the South Island.

Didymo is not known to be present in the North Island.

Its arrival in New Zealand is the first recorded occurrence in the southern hemisphere. Its natural distribution is the northern part of the northern hemisphere.

Didymo is not considered a significant human health risk.

Description

Didymo is a freshwater diatom (type of alga). It can form massive blooms on the bottoms of streams, rivers and occasionally on lake edges where there is wave action.

The alga attaches itself to the streambed by stalks. These stalks can form a thick brown mat that smothers rocks, submerged plants and other materials. Established mats form flowing streamers that can turn white at their ends and look similar to tissue paper.

Although the algae appears slimy, it feels like wet cotton wool.

Stop the spread

Didymo is made up of cells that cannot be seen with the naked eye until large colonies form. It only takes one of these cells to survive and be transported to a nearby waterway for didymo to spread. Didymo cells thrive in freshwater and if you are cleaning with freshwater you are helping to keep them alive.

Didymo is an unwanted organism under the Biosecurity Act 1993. Under the Act those knowingly spreading an unwanted organism can be liable for up to five years' imprisonment and/or a $100,000 fine.

To ensure you do not spread didymo, wherever possible restrict equipment, boats, clothing and other items for exclusive use in a single waterway.

If you are moving items between waterways you must:

1. **Check**: Before leaving the river, remove all obvious clumps of algae and look for hidden clumps. Leave them at the affected site. If you find any later, do not wash them down drains. Treat them with the approved cleaning methods below, dry them and put them in a rubbish bin.
2. **Clean**: Soak and scrub all items for at least one minute in either, hot (60°C) water, a two percent solution of household bleach or a five percent solution of salt, nappy cleaner, antiseptic hand cleaner or dishwashing detergent. A two percent solution is 200ml, a five percent solution is 500ml (two large cups), with water added to make 10 litres.
3. **Dry**: If cleaning is not practical, after the item is completely dry to touch, wait an additional 48 hours before contact or use in any other waterway.

THE THREAT

Didymo is an invasive species that can form massive blooms. Thick growths can adversely affect freshwater fish, plant and invertebrate species by reducing the number of suitable habitats.



If you require more information please visit:

www.biosecurity.govt.nz/didymo

To report a suspected find of didymo please call 0800 80 99 66

June 2006

MAF BIOSECURITY NEW ZEALAND

TEAM NUMBER: _____

Korowai 'Office Hours' Rogaine – Sunday 2 December '07
Indemnity and Emergency Contact

Teams will not be registered until the following has been completed and presented at the administration desk.

Indemnity

We, the undersigned, hereby acknowledge that the New Zealand Rogaining Association, the Event Organizers, and the owners of the land used for this event, accept no liability for any loss, damage or injury to ourselves (including vehicles at the event venue) resulting from our participation in this event. We enter this event at our own risk and acknowledge that there may be risks associated with the sport of Rogaining. We understand the safety requirements set out by the organisers.

Name	Signature	Date	Date of birth

Emergency Contact

Your name and Car Registration Number	Emergency Contact (not a competitor) Name, Address, Phone No.	Allergies or Medical Condition

NOTE:

1. A parent or guardian must sign the indemnity form on behalf of a competitor under the age of 18.
2. Supply the name, address and telephone number of a person to contact in the event of an emergency. This person must not be a competitor in the event.
3. Supply details of any medical conditions or allergies that might be of assistance to First Aid staff in the event of an accident or emergency.